

APPLE – INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

About the Company:

An internship at **Apple** has always felt like a dream come true for many tech enthusiasts, and I was no exception. Apple, the company that's always been a step ahead in tech, is based in Cupertino, California. It's been shaping the future for as long as I can remember. I had the privilege of interning at their **Hyderabad campus**, which is a hub of innovation in India. The work here focuses on areas like **maps development**, **machine learning**, and **analytics**, all while fostering a collaborative environment. What stood out most to me was how much emphasis is placed on solving real-world problems with real impact.

This internship was not just a professional milestone but also an opportunity for immense personal growth. Working alongside industry experts and contributing to meaningful projects made it a truly rewarding journey.

Internship Details:

- **Timeline:** January 2025 – June 2025.
- **Role:** Software Dev Eng. in Test Intern(SDET Intern).
- **Monthly Stipend:** ₹105,000 per month.
- **Monthly Housing Allowance:** ₹35,100 per month.
- **Relocation Services:** One time Economy-class round trip and relocation assistance for 6 months.

Interview Process

The selection process comprised the following stages:

1. Online Test (Eliminatory)
2. Resume Shortlisting
3. Interview Round 1: Technical & Eliminatory
4. Interview Round 2: Techno-Managerial

Online Test

The first stage of the Apple SDET internship process was an online assessment. This round included:

- **Coding Questions:** Two problems related to arrays and strings, rated as easy to medium difficulty.
- **Technical MCQs:** A set of 6-7 multiple-choice and multi-select questions covering software engineering and testing concepts.

Honestly, my coursework in Software Engineering turned out to be a lifesaver here. It helped me approach the MCQs confidently, and overall, this round felt pretty straightforward.

Interview Round 1: Technical

This round was eliminatory and was conducted via Webex Video and CoderPad. It involved **live coding**, where you code and compile while explaining your approach.

Coding Questions:

1. Add Two Numbers Represented by Two Arrays

- **Problem Overview:** You are given two arrays representing two numbers. Each array's elements correspond to the digits of the number. The task is to compute their sum and return the result as another array.
- **Approach:**
 - Traverse both arrays from the last digit to the first, maintaining a carry for sums exceeding 9.
 - Append result digits to a new array in reverse order, then reverse it to get the final answer.

2. Linked List Problem:

- The interviewer posed subquestions of the above question to evaluate edge case handling and optimization of code.

3. Resume-Based Discussion:

- The second half of the interview revolved around my **research internship project (DeepFake Related)**. The interviewer asked technical questions that dug deep into the project's workings. Since I had prepared thoroughly and knew the project inside out, I felt confident handling these questions.

Key Takeaways:

Apple interviewers are subject-matter experts who tailor their questions to your resume. This ensures discussions are meaningful and relevant, which I found incredibly refreshing.

Interview Round 2: Techno-Managerial

Round 2 was all about seeing if I clicked with Apple's culture—how well I work with others, handle challenges, and adapt to new situations.

Nature of Questions:

- **Situational challenges like:** *"How would you handle a disagreement with a teammate?"* or *"Can you share a moment when you were inspired by someone?"* etc.
- The questions were dynamic, and several were fired back-to-back, which kept the conversation lively.

Key Takeaways:

1. **Be Honest:** Just be yourself—honesty goes a long way. If you're genuine, people can tell, and that makes all the difference.
2. **Show Confidence:** Share your thoughts assertively, backed by clear examples from your work or projects. For instance, when discussing teamwork, I linked it to a group project I had worked on, showcasing how collaboration and adaptability helped us achieve success.
3. **Be Relatable:** Even for general questions, I found ways to connect them to my professional or personal journey. For example, as a GenAI enthusiast, I shared how attending conferences in Chennai shaped my learning, exposing me to industry trends, Industry leaders and life lessons. The interviewers appreciated these stories, as they highlighted both technical and personal growth.

The interviewers made the whole experience feel chill and engaging. By the end, I felt like I had made some great connections, which speaks volumes about Apple's commitment to ensuring a positive and enriching candidate experience.

Key Takeaways for Juniors

1. **Engage with Alumni:** Proactively connect with seniors from various companies to gain diverse and valuable insights. Since Apple visited our campus for the first time, we were the fresh batch to experience their recruitment process, making external perspectives even more crucial for preparation.
2. **Master DSA:** Trust me, a solid grasp of data structures and algorithms is a game-changer. Don't skip the basics—they come up everywhere.
3. **Know Your Projects:** Be well-versed in the technical details of your projects, as interviewers will test your depth of understanding. Deploying projects, when possible, adds practical credibility.
4. **Highlight Relevant Skills:** Include only those skills on your resume that you are confident in discussing or demonstrating during interviews.
5. **Prepare Thoughtful Questions:** At the end of interviews, ask insightful questions about Apple's culture, the team you might work with, or the values they uphold. It shows genuine interest and curiosity.
6. **Showcase Your Thinking:** While solving problems during interviews, articulate your approach clearly. Even a brute force method is a good starting point before optimizing your solution.
7. **Understand Apple's Vision:** Research Apple's core values and work culture. Be ready to discuss how your skills and experiences align with their mission.
8. **Maintain Academic Excellence:** While practical skills are critical, a strong CGPA reflects your commitment and discipline, often acting as an additional advantage.
9. **Craft a Crisp Resume:** A clean, focused resume with impactful projects and relevant skills can make a strong first impression. Avoid clutter or exaggeration.

10. **Iterative Problem Solving:** Instead of feeling pressured to provide the most efficient solution upfront, focus on starting with a basic approach and iteratively improving it during discussions.

Key Resources:

1. **DSA (Data Structures & Algorithms):**

- Striver's SDE Sheet
- YouTube Channels:
 - Striver (takeUforward)
 - Love Babbar (CodeHelp)
 - Abdul Bari
- Practice Platforms:
 - LeetCode
 - GeeksforGeeks

2. **Core Subjects (OS, DBMS, OOPS, CN, SE):**

- Gate Smashers
- KnowledgeGate
- Kunal Kushwaha
- Apna College

3. **AI/ML(for projects in this domain)**

- Krish Naik
- freeCodeCamp

Wishing You the Best of Luck!

I hope my experience can give you a heads-up as you prepare for your own journey—good luck, and don't forget to enjoy the ride!

Feel free to connect with me on LinkedIn or drop me an email if you have any questions or need guidance. I'd be happy to help!

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Wishing you all the best! I can't wait to see many of you get your dream internships or jobs. You've got this! 😊